Sandith Hewage

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EDUCATION

University of California San Diego Expected Jun 2027
Bachelor of Science in Cognitive Science, Specialization in Design and Interaction La Jolla, CA
Relevant Coursework: UX Design, Interaction Design, Data Science, Cognitive Neuroscience

EXPERIENCE

Y STEM and Chess Inc | *User Experience (UX) Engineer · San Diego, CA (Remote)* Oct 2026 – Present

- Lead UI/UX as the sole designer on a 20-person team and mentor a design intern; promoted from intern in 4 months
- Built a 30-component React library on Tailwind CSS design tokens and CVA variants, meeting WCAG 2.2 AA
- Designed 21 mobile screens that halved new-user onboarding time (about 20 to 10 minutes) in a live rollout
- Developed a real-time AI chess tutor (Stockfish + Claude API) giving move-by-move feedback, used by 90% of students in the learning section
- Conduct code reviews and set front-end architecture standards for UI development

Y STEM and Chess Inc | *Full Stack Software Engineer Intern · San Diego, CA (Remote)* Jun 2026 – Oct 2026

- Led a full-stack UI/UX redesign of a nonprofit chess, math, and CS platform serving 500+ underserved students
- Conducted user research with students and educators to shape user flows for neurodivergent learners
- Defined the platform's mobile-first visual language in a design.md spec that lets AI coding agents build on-brand UI

Scabs | *Co-Founder, Lead Designer & Creative Director · Los Angeles, CA* Sep 2024 – Present

- Own all design, web development, and graphics for a streetwear brand run by 4 co-founders
- Design and build the Shopify storefront (HTML, CSS, JS, Liquid); first drop sold 86% of stock for $8,900
- Added a sizing calculator after competitive analysis and usability testing, cutting sizing questions by 95% (from about 10 a week to 2 a month)
- Prioritized mobile-first layouts in Figma after analytics showed 80%+ of traffic comes from Instagram

2nd Street USA | *Sales Associate & Assistant Buyer · Torrance, CA* Nov 2023 – Nov 2024

- Promoted to Assistant Buyer in 7 months; scaled listings from 5 to 30 per week, lifting daily sales revenue by 23%

PROJECTS

Queue: Restaurant Wait Experience Design sandith.com/queue

- Surveyed and interviewed 16 diners; used affinity mapping to design a wait system built on confidence ranges
- Ran moderated A/B usability tests (n=7) measuring task success and time on task; all 7 preferred the redesign

Smart DND: iOS Notification Redesign sandith.com/smart-dnd

- Interviewed 18 users and found iOS Focus is organized around apps, while users think in terms of people
- Prototyped a cross-app prioritization system with a transparent reasoning UI, understood by all 5 think-aloud testers

MTS Trolley Doors: Transit Interaction Design (Team Project) sandith.com/mts

- Ran a 30-rider field study with naturalistic observation and intercept interviews, uncovering a door feedback gap
- Designed a four-state door interaction model using brightness, shape, and color for accessible feedback

SKILLS

Development: React, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, class-variance-authority (CVA), Component Libraries, Design Tokens, Responsive Design, Shopify Liquid, Python, Git, Claude API
Design: Figma, Design Systems, Prototyping, Wireframing, Interaction Design, UI Design, Visual Design, Information Architecture, Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)
Research: User Interviews, Surveys, Field Observation, Affinity Mapping, Moderated Usability Testing, Think-Aloud Protocol, A/B Testing, Competitive Analysis, Journey Mapping
Tools: Claude Code, Claude Design, GitHub, Shopify, Adobe Creative Cloud